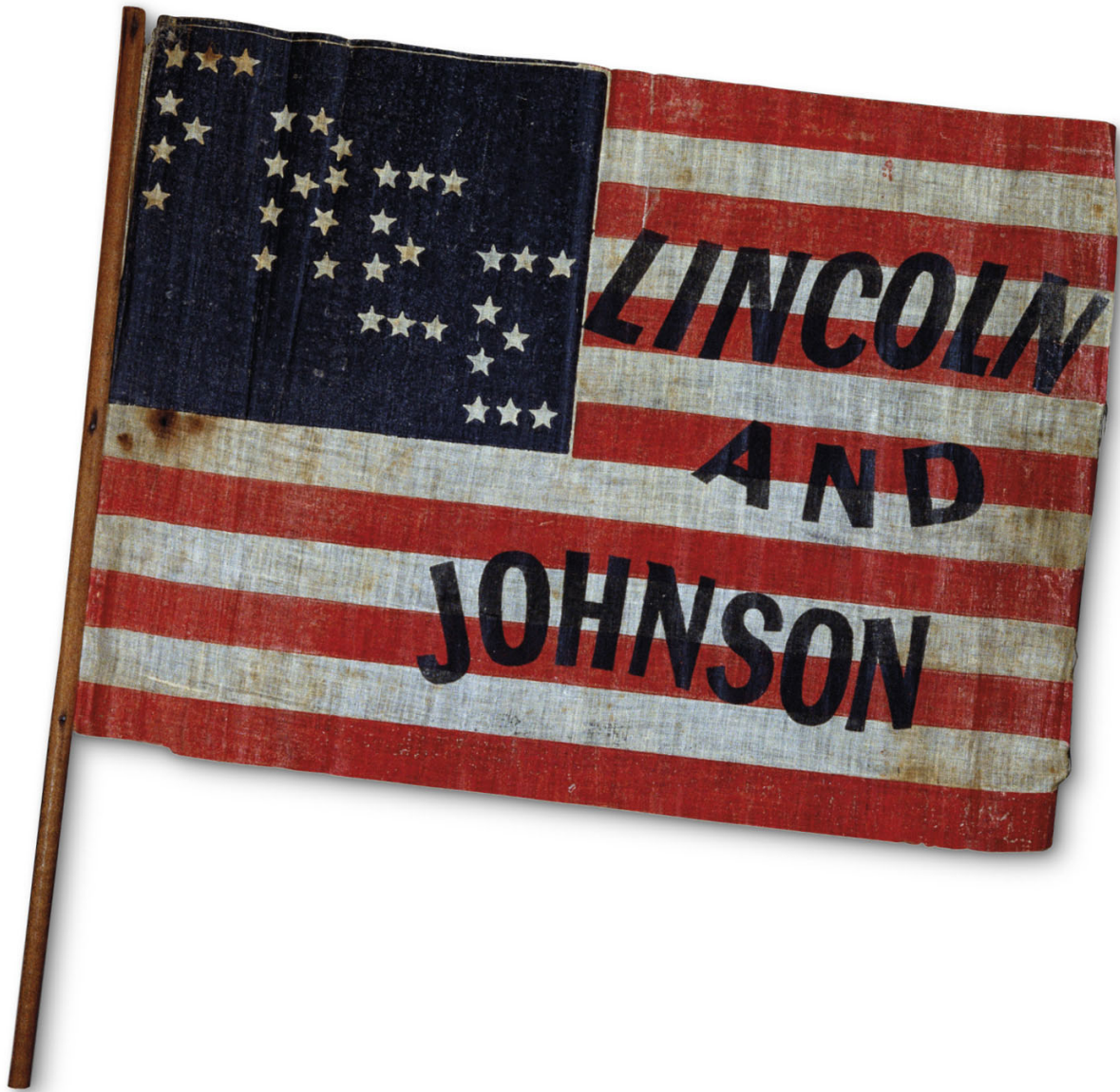




Campaign flag

The Republican Party chose War Democrat Johnson to run with Abraham Lincoln in the 1864 presidential election in the hope of uniting pro-war opinion. They easily beat George McClellan, the Democratic candidate.

Taking office

Johnson's first public appearance in his role as vice president did not inspire confidence. Suffering the after-effects of typhoid fever, he prepared for his swearing in with several shots of whiskey. He gave a rambling, incoherent inauguration speech and was generally held to have disgraced himself. Six weeks later, following the seismic